Video Marketing Checklist

PROJECT READINESS GUIDE · STRATEGY TO DISTRIBUTION

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Stories Worth telling

Use this guide before your next video project to close the gap between what you produce and the results you actually need. Each checkpoint has a clear purpose and a measurable outcome — because good video without strategy is just expensive content.

01 STRATEGY & DISCOVERY

- ☐ **Define the communication objective**
  State in one sentence what you need the viewer to think, feel, or do after watching. If you can't, you're not ready to shoot.
  → **Every creative decision has a benchmark to measure against.**
- ☐ **Identify the primary audience**
  Name the specific person — their role, their pain point, where they'll watch this. "Everyone" is not an audience.
  → **Message and tone are calibrated. Relevance is built in.**
- ☐ **Map to the buyer or stakeholder journey**
  Awareness, consideration, or decision? Each stage demands a different story, depth, and call to action.
  → **Content lands at the right moment and doesn't confuse the viewer.**
- ☐ **Audit what already exists**
  Before producing, check existing assets. What can be repurposed, recut, or built on? Don't start from zero by default.
  → **Budget is protected. Effort is directed at genuine gaps.**

02 PRE-PRODUCTION & NARRATIVE

- ☐ **Build the story before the shot list**
  Write the narrative arc: hook, tension, resolution. The camera follows the story — not the other way around.
  → **Less wasted footage. Stronger emotional throughline.**
- ☐ **Identify your proof point or hero moment**
  What single moment, stat, or story makes this undeniable? Build everything around it. Vague videos exist because this was never found.
  → **The video has a centre of gravity the viewer remembers.**
- ☐ **Confirm approvals and stakeholders upfront**
  Know exactly who signs off and at which stage. Approval fatigue kills good work. Set a process before production begins.
  → **Fewer revision rounds. Budget stays intact. Timelines hold.**
- ☐ **Set the distribution plan before you shoot**
  Where will this live? Platform determines length, format, and aspect ratio. Decide upfront — not in post.
  → **Content built once, distributed intentionally — not retrofitted.**

03 PRODUCTION

- ☐ **Capture authentic human moments**
  Interviews, candid reactions, real environments. Your audience responds to truth. Avoid anything that looks like a stock shoot.
  → **Trust is built. The brand feels real, not manufactured.**
- ☐ **Shoot for multiple formats**
  Capture landscape and vertical where possible. Get wider and tighter variations of key moments. The content cascade only works if the raw material supports it.
  → **One shoot day fuels weeks of content across platforms.**
- ☐ **Record clean audio — non-negotiable**
  Viewers forgive average visuals. They abandon poor audio immediately. Lapel mics for interviews, boom for ambient. Budget here before anything else.
  → **Production quality perceived as high regardless of camera budget.**

04 POST-PRODUCTION & DELIVERY

- ☐ **Edit for message, not duration**
  Every cut must serve the story. The right length is when nothing can be removed without losing meaning. There is no universal rule — only strategic intention.
  → **Retention increases. Drop-off points are minimised.**
- ☐ **Caption and subtitle every deliverable**
  85% of social video is watched without sound. Captions are not optional — they are access, reach, and SEO combined.
  → **Wider audience, improved accessibility, better organic reach.**
- ☐ **Export versioned cuts per platform**
  A 90-second LinkedIn cut, a 30-second reel, a 15-second hook. Each platform has different algorithm behaviour and viewer patience thresholds.
  → **Content performs natively on each channel — not as a compromise.**

05 DISTRIBUTION & AMPLIFICATION

- ☐ **Match platform to audience intent**
  LinkedIn = professional context, decision-makers. YouTube = deep research, trust-building. Instagram = culture and credibility. Posting everywhere the same way is waste.
  → Reach the right people where they're already paying attention.
- ☐ **Run the content cascade**
  One project becomes many: full film on YouTube, clips on LinkedIn, carousel on Instagram, hook on TikTok. Plan this before distribution — not as an afterthought.
  → Maximum ROI from a single production investment.
- ☐ **Amplify your highest-performing content**
  Use paid only to amplify what's already working organically. Spending money on weak content doesn't fix the content — it accelerates its failure.
  → Paid budget yields multiplied returns on proven creative.

06 MEASUREMENT & ITERATION

- ☐ **Set KPIs before launch — not after**
  Awareness: views, reach, share rate. Engagement: watch time, comments, saves. Conversion: clicks, enquiries, pipeline value. Define success in advance or you'll rationalise any result.
  → Performance data becomes actionable, not decorative.
- ☐ **Track drop-off, not just views**
  Where do people stop watching? That's your edit note for the next video. Average view duration tells you more about narrative strength than total view count.
  → Every video makes the next one better.
- ☐ **Schedule a post-campaign debrief**
  What worked, what didn't, what would you change. Document it. Build institutional knowledge into your comms function — don't start from zero next time.
  → Compounding returns on strategy over time.

INTERNAL COMMS (use this for)

CEO town hall films
Onboarding & culture videos
Change management messaging
Training series
Impact reports (staff)
Behind-the-scenes culture docs

EXTERNAL COMMS (use this for)

Brand & founder story films
Thought leadership series
Donor & stakeholder appeals
Client testimonials
Campaign & launch content
LinkedIn & YouTube strategy

Ready to build videos that perform?

We help brands and organisations close the gap between the work they do and how the world sees them — through strategy-first video storytelling. Every engagement starts with a discovery call. No pitch. Just thinking.

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